

VIDYA VENKAPPA

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EDUCATION

University of Washington, Seattle <i>Master of Science in Information Systems</i> 🏆 Graduated with Honors - Ranked Top 10 among 100+ students in the cohort.	Jun 2024 – Jun 2025 3.85/4
Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore <i>M.Tech in Data Science and Business Analytics</i> 🏆 Awarded full sponsorship by Cisco - Selected among 20 employees across the company.	Aug 2021 – July 2023 3.87/4
PES University, Bangalore <i>B.Tech in Computer Science with Data Science Specialization</i> 🏆 Awarded 2 CNR Rao merit scholarships for academic excellence at PES University with 25% tuition waiver.	Aug 2015 – Aug 2019 9.16/10

WORK EXPERIENCE

Radiant Logistics, Seattle <i>AI Engineer - Mentor: CTO, Mr. Laurent Grousseau</i> - Built an LLM-powered agentic customs pipeline using Google ADK, automating document workflows and saving approximately \$70K annually. - Developed a PostgreSQL MCP server enabling AI agents to generate analytics dashboards from enterprise data in under 5 minutes. - Built a conversational AI agent generation platform that transforms user requirements into deployed GCP agents automatically. - Automated shipment processing and quote generation from email requests, cutting response time from 24 hrs to 5 mins (95% improvement). - Built a logistics platform enabling customer and internal teams to manage daily operations without external applications.	Jan 2026 – Present
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor <i>Research Assistant at IDEA lab - Mentor: Prof. Venkatesh Potluri</i> - Developed a dataset to evaluate LLM performance on software development tasks and measure accessibility knowledge across different models. - Built A1lyBench, a benchmarking platform for analyzing trends in Agent performance on accessibility-focused software engineering tasks.	Aug 2025 – Jan 2026
Cisco Systems, Bangalore <i>Software Engineer II [Grade 6] (2021-2024) - Software Engineer I [Grade 4] (2019–2021)</i> - Built a RAG pipeline that improved response quality by 70%, leveraging diverse enterprise data sources to generate accurate LLM responses. - Engineered LLM-based politeness controls using few-shot prompting, achieved 90% positive sentiment across varied user tones. - Led the BotLite's migration from a monolithic to scalable microservices architecture. Improving application performance and reliability. - Launched an analytics dashboard providing insights into bot engagement, driving 100+ new bots, 10K+ users, and 70% faster responses. 🏆 Awarded "Emerging Talent of the Year" and 25+ Cisco Connected Recognitions for early-career excellence	Jan 2019 – Jun 2024

RELEVANT PROJECTS

<u>CRAB.AI: Critical Review and Analysis for Brilliant Papers</u> 🔗 <i>Mentor: Prof. Leonard Boussieux</i> Built an AI-assisted paper review platform using React, FastAPI, and LLMs (Gemini, Perplexity, DeepSeek), reducing review time from 4 months to 1 week while enhancing submission quality and fairness. 🏆 Won Most Creative Pitch & Product Award at <u>UW MSIS Demo Day</u> for CRAB.AI	Dec 2024 – Mar 2025
<u>iCareSee: An AI-Driven Vision Care Platform</u> 🔗 <i>Mentor: Mr. Nick Malik</i> Designed AI architecture for iCareSee, a mobile/web platform improving vision screening and eyeglass delivery for 100M+ underserved Indians, accelerating diagnosis and expanding access in low-connectivity areas. 🏆 Secured 1st place in <u>SITAC</u> competition and was awarded \$2000 by CITAP	Dec 2024 – May 2025
<u>Microsoft Digital Defense Report Analysis</u> 🔗 <i>Mentor: Prof. Bob Bruns</i> Built a RAG pipeline using ChromaDB, LangChain, and Phi-3.5 to extract cyber threat insights from Microsoft Digital Defense Reports (2020 to 2024), enabling 2-minute access to key information from 80 - 120 page documents and supporting strategic mitigation decisions.	Dec 2024 – Feb 2025
<u>Microsoft Security Incident Prediction</u> 🔗 <i>Mentor: Prof. Bob Bruns</i> Developed a CatBoost based security incident classification model using the Microsoft Guide dataset, applying regression analysis and feature engineering to achieve 80% accuracy and improve threat detection efficiency.	Oct 2024 – Dec 2024

RESEARCH WORK

<u>SMACC: Streamlining Multi-Modal Abstractive and Extractive Summarization</u> 🔗 <i>Graduate Thesis (Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore) - Mentor: Prof. Deepak Subramani</i> Built a meeting summarization system using LLMs (DialogLM, Longformer) with a novel "Chunking and Chaining" technique to handle long transcripts and generate extractive video trailers for quick visual highlights.	July 2023
<u>Automatic Subtitle Generation for Videos</u> 🔗 <i>6th International Conference on Advanced Computing and Communication Systems (ICACCS) - Mentor: Prof. Badri Prasad</i> Undergraduate Thesis (PES University, Bangalore): Developed an offline media player that generates subtitles by extracting audio from video files and applying speech recognition via CMU Sphinx and DeepSpeech.	Mar 2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Tools and Libraries React, Typescript, Python, PyTorch, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Scikit-learn, GCP, ADK, Postgres SQL, MongoDB